MD. FORIDUL ISLAM LABU

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RESEARCH PROFILE

Education researcher and PhD applicant with research and applied experience in Bangladesh and the United Kingdom. Experienced in qualitative and mixed-methods research, disability-inclusive education, child-rights fieldwork and education policy. Second author of a peer-reviewed study on child labour and education policy in urban slums, published in 2026, with a further co-authored manuscript under review. My research focuses on how education policies and institutional practices shape access, participation and inclusive provision for marginalised learners in Bangladesh and other under-resourced contexts in the Global South.

Research interests: inclusive education and disability-responsive education policy; education policy implementation and inclusive practice in Bangladesh and the Global South; educational inequality, exclusion and access for marginalised learners.

EDUCATION

MA Education Studies, University of Portsmouth, UK 2023 – 2024
Merit overall; Dissertation: 75/100 (Distinction)

Dissertation: "Exploring the Research Culture Among University Teachers: A Perspective from Bangladesh"

Relevant modules: Inclusive Education; SEN Support and Policy; Educational Psychology; Leadership and Strategy; Research Methods in Education.

BEd Psychology and Special Education, University of Rajshahi, Bangladesh 2016 – 2020
CGPA 3.47/4.00, First Class

Relevant modules: Child Development; Learning Disabilities; Curriculum Design; Inclusive Teaching Practices; Educational Psychology.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

MA Dissertation Research, University of Portsmouth 2023 – 2024 | UK and Bangladesh

- Independently designed a qualitative case study, conducted semi-structured interviews with faculty at the Institute of Education and Research, University of Rajshahi, and completed NVivo-supported thematic analysis.

Project Assistant, Research, World Linkup Jun 2022 – Dec 2022 | Dhaka, Bangladesh

- Conducted field research and consolidated evidence from partner organisations, coordinating cross-institutional documentation and stakeholder reporting.

Research Assistant, Baseline Study on Education and Rehabilitation for Children with Disabilities, Save the Children International Jun 2022 – Aug 2022 | Sylhet, Bangladesh

- Under the supervision of the lead researcher, Professor Happy Kumar Das (Institute of Education and Research, University of Rajshahi), conducted household- and child-level interviews and field observations across multiple sites for a mixed-methods baseline study on school reintegration for children with disabilities.
- Recorded and organised field data supporting the project's evidence base for programme design and target-setting.

Research Assistant, Child Rights Situation Analysis, Save the Children International Apr 2022 – May 2022 | Bangladesh

- Carried out field data collection under the direction of the lead researcher, Professor Happy Kumar Das (Institute of Education and Research, University of Rajshahi) for a national situation analysis of child-rights service facilities and organisational capacity.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed journal article

Khan Puspita, M., **Islam Labu, M. F.**, Jahan, M. S., Kamruzzaman Fahad, M., Sud Uddin Sadi, M., & Nurkutubul Alam, M. (2026). Child labour, education policy, and lived experiences in Rajshahi's slums: A qualitative case study. *South Asian Journal of Social Sciences and Humanities*, *7*(5), 142–159. https://doi.org/10.48165/sajssh.2026.7508

Under review

Islam Labu, M. F., & Poole, R. (2026). *Teaching workload and research engagement in Bangladeshi public universities* [Manuscript under review]. Developed from MA dissertation research.

TEACHING AND INCLUSIVE EDUCATION EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Special Educational Needs, Engage Education — Jun 2026 – Present | UK

- Implement teacher-directed interventions, document learner progress and communicate observations while maintaining safeguarding requirements.

Teaching Assistant, Special Educational Needs, Engage Education — Feb 2024 – Aug 2024 | UK

- Supported inclusive classroom participation for learners aged 3–16 by adapting instruction to individual needs and sharing developmental observations with teachers and families.

Project Coordinator (Part-time), TARS Engineering School — Jan 2020 – May 2022 | Bangladesh

- Planned three educational workshops serving more than 50 children; maintained developmental records and coordinated programme budgets and stakeholder reporting.

Intern Teacher, PHT Centre — Jan 2020 – Jun 2020 | Rajshahi, Bangladesh

- Taught social science and developed Individualised Education Programmes for Year 4 learners with additional needs.

OTHER EMPLOYMENT

Warehouse Operative, Adecco — Sep 2025 – Mar 2026 | UK

Sales Executive, Candles and Oud — Sep 2024 – Sep 2025 | UK

RESEARCH SKILLS

- **Qualitative:** semi-structured interviews, thematic analysis, case study design, ethnographic approaches
- **Quantitative:** survey design, structured field data collection, baseline and evaluation studies
- **Research practice:** literature review, research design, research ethics, academic writing, evaluation reporting
- **Software:** NVivo, SPSS, Microsoft Office, Google Workspace

LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

- General Secretary, Bangla Society, University of Portsmouth (Jul 2024 – Jun 2025): coordinated organisational operations, events and member engagement.
- Founding Member and Joint Secretary, Rajshahi University Education Club, University of Rajshahi (Sep 2020 – Jun 2022): co-founded the club; organised academic events and community outreach.
- General Member, Community Policing Forum, Bangladesh (Mar 2018 – Jan 2020).
- Volunteer, Student Campaign Groups, UN Women Bangladesh: Building Capacity to Prevent Violence Against Women project, funded by the Embassy of Sweden (2017 – 2018).

TRAINING AND CERTIFICATES

- Prevention of Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (PSEA), UNICEF via Agora (2021)
- Ethics and Integrity at UNICEF, UNICEF via Agora (2021)
- Youth Vote Matters workshop, JAAGO Foundation and Volunteers for Bangladesh (2018)

AWARDS

Finalist, Edupreneurship Idea Quest, National Level, Bangladesh (2017)

LANGUAGES

Bengali (native); English (fluent): MA taught and assessed in the UK; IELTS Academic Overall 7.0 (2023)

REFERENCES

Available on request.÷